PREMIER BUSINESS ACADEMY

● PERSONALISED ROADMAP · STAGE 3 · $2M–$5M

The Manufacturer's PROFIT ROADMAP

The business runs without you most days. Now turn what you built into something genuinely valuable.

7
AREAS

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STAGE 3 DIAGNOSIS

Where You Are The Honest Truth You're doing $2M–$5M. The business actually runs without you most days. But there's a difference between "running" and "thriving" - and between a business that's profitable and one that's valuable. The questions change here.

W H AT THISFEELSLIKE

For the first time in years, you have breathing room. The factory runs. People step up. You take a week off and nobody panics. But now a different restlessness sets in. You built this from nothing - and now that it doesn't need you every day, you wonder what's next. The operational pressure is gone; in its place, the weight of strategic decisions nobody else can make.

12 MONTHS FROM NOW

If nothing changes, you'll still have a good business - but one worth far less than it could be. The value is still tied to your relationships, your reputation, your decisions. Not the systems.

$2M+ revenue Fewer than 5% of NZ manufacturers reach this stage. Even fewer turn it into something sellable at a real multiplier.

> ***"At this stage, the questions change. It's no longer 'how do I survive?' It's 'what is this thing worth, and what do I want it to become?'"***
>
> — Bernard Powell

What you'll read next Production - SOPs and quality systems. Sales & Pricing - cost-per-unit and quote discipline. Cash Flow - Friday rhythm and forecasting. People - delegation and retention. Systems - documented process ownership. Marketing - referrals and lead consistency. Your Role - shifting from worker to owner.

AREA 1 OF 7

Production Team owns quality. 100+ improvements a quarter. Does it get better without you?

Your team runs the floor. 100+ improvements per quarter. You're barely in production. But the question is: does the system get BETTER without you? If you're still setting improvement targets, you're still the brain of the operation.

$500+/hr of your time Every hour on production is an hour NOT spent on the $5M strategy. A single week on the floor costs $20K+ in unrealised growth moves.

The Fix:
1. Set a quarterly innovation challenge. "Reduce waste by 10%" or "Cut setup time by 20%." Let the team own the solution.
2. Reward results. Bonus, team lunch, trophy. Make innovation the culture.
3. Your new role: set the target, review results. Once a month. Not daily, not weekly.

> ***"At Premier, the team started suggesting improvements I'd never thought of. That's when I knew the system was working - when the factory got better WITHOUT me."***
>
> — Bernard Powell

Bernard's note The first SOP should be ugly. A phone video, a checklist, and one clear quality standard beat another month of explaining the job from scratch. Clean it up later - the real win is getting the process out of your head.

AREA 2 OF 7

Sales & Pricing Sales process documented. Team closes. But is revenue still capped by your calendar?

Sales process is documented. Your team closes deals. But if you're still the only one who can close big deals, revenue is capped by your calendar. At $2M+ you need channels, not just conversations.

Revenue cap: your calendar Every big deal you personally close is proof the system isn't ready. Your job now is to build the sales engine, not run it.

The Fix:

1. Document the full sales process. Every move, every email template, every objection handler.
2. Train 1–2 people to close. Start with smaller deals. Build the rep.
3. Build channel partnerships - revenue that doesn't need your calendar.

> ***"The day someone else closed a $200K deal without me in the room was the day Premier Group became a real company, not a one-man show."***
>
> — Bernard Powell

Common trap Owners often mistake a fast yes for a good quote. The goal is not to win every job. The goal is to win the right work at the right margin, with a method someone else can repeat.

AREA 3 OF 7

Cash Flow Always positive. 15%+ margins. Question: how do you deploy $300K+/yr?

Cash flow is always positive. 15%+ net margins. Reserves are building. The question isn't "how do I make money?" It's "how do I deploy $300K+ a year of profit for maximum return?" Park it wrong and growth stalls. Spend it wrong and it evaporates.

$300K+/yr - deployed or wasted If profit sits doing nothing, it's not safety - it's stagnation. If it goes into random purchases, it's waste. The question is how to deploy it to hit $5M.

The Fix:
1. Build a 6-month cash reserve. Then set up a separate growth fund - 10% of profit, auto- transferred monthly.
2. Get a proper business valuation done. Know the number before you make big calls.
3. Write a capital allocation policy. Three buckets only: equipment, marketing, talent.

> ***"Cash reserves aren't boring. They're what let you say yes to opportunities and no to bad deals. That's freedom."***
>
> **— Bernard Powell**

At this stage Cash flow discipline is less about finance jargon and more about facing reality weekly. A simple forecast reviewed every Friday beats a sophisticated spreadsheet you avoid opening.

AREA 4 OF 7

People Real leaders have emerged. Are you developing them, or just managing?

Real leaders have emerged. Retention is strong. But are you developing leaders or just managing workers? The difference decides whether you stay at $2M or scale to $5M. Owner-dependent businesses sell at 1–2× earnings. Leader-led ones sell at 4–6×. Same revenue. Different outcome.

2× vs 6× multiplier Owner-dependent = $600K exit. Leader-led = $4.5M exit. The earnings are the same - the multiplier is everything.

The Fix:
1. Identify your top 3 people. Give each a P&L they own - a department, product line, or region.
2. Let them hire, fire, and manage budgets. Real authority. Meet monthly to review results.
3. Invest $5K–$10K/yr per leader in development. The ROI is 100×.

> ***"When I built Premier to 62 staff, I didn't manage 62 people. I managed 5 leaders who managed everyone else."***
>
> **— Bernard Powell**

Bernard's note Most delegation fails because the standard was never clear enough to inspect. Give people the process, the expected result, and a review point. Then coach the gap instead of taking the job back.

AREA 5 OF 7

Systems Systems run 4+ weeks without you. Are they sellable?

Systems are self-improving. The business runs 4+ weeks without you. But could you sell it for what it's actually worth? The difference between "runs" and "sellable" is documentation, leadership depth, and whether decisions are made by a system or a person.

$300K vs $2.4M at sale Owner-dependent businesses exit at 1–2× earnings. Systems-driven ones exit at 4–8×. Same business. Different multiplier.

The Fix:
1. Get a business valuation. Identify the 3 things dragging your multiplier down.
2. Document the management system - not just production. How decisions get made. How people get trained and promoted.
3. A buyer pays for the SYSTEM, not the product. Fix each owner-dependency over the next 12 months.

> ***"I built Premier to be sellable from day one. Every system I documented, every leader I developed, every process I automated added to the value."***
>
> — Bernard Powell

Common trap If a process cannot survive your day off, it is not yet a system. Document the trigger, the steps, and what "done right" looks like. Then test whether someone else can run it without chasing you.

AREA 6 OF 7

Marketing Multiple channels running. Now: make marketing a department.

Multiple channels are running. Pipeline is predictable. But the referrals that got you to $2M won't get you to $5M. Marketing needs to become a department - with budget, people, and accountability. Product isn't the gap to $5M. Distribution is.

$3M in unrealised revenue The gap from $2M to $5M is almost always marketing and sales capacity - not product. Distribution is the lever.

The Fix:
1. Run 2–3 channels in parallel: Google Ads, LinkedIn, a formalised referral programme.
2. Hire a marketing person or agency. Budget: 5–8% of revenue.
3. Track cost per lead and cost per customer by channel. Kill what doesn't work.

> ***"Marketing is a production line for customers. You'd never run your factory without a schedule. Don't run your pipeline without one either."***
>
> **— Bernard Powell**

At this stage Referrals work best when you ask right after a win, not when things go quiet. One simple referral question used every month is stronger than a grand marketing plan nobody owns.

AREA 7 OF 7

Your Role Working ON the business - about 30 hours a week. What are those hours for?

Working about 30 hours a week. Strategy and growth only. But are you spending those hours on the $5M plan - or filling them with meetings that make you feel busy? At this stage, your time is the single most expensive and most leveraged asset in the company. Use it accordingly.

$260,000/yr lost Your time is worth $500+/hr at this stage. 10 wasted hours per week = $260K/yr in lost strategic value.

The Fix:

1. Monday: Review dashboards, set priorities. 2 hours.
2. Tue/Wed: Customer and partner meetings. Strategy and innovation. The $5M plan.
3. Thu/Fri: Leadership 1:1s, then close out the week by 2pm Friday.

> ***"My best weeks at Premier were the ones where nobody needed me for anything. That's not lazy - that's leadership."***
>
> — Bernard Powell

Bernard's note Your highest-value work is choosing priorities, removing blockers, and making better decisions earlier. Every recurring task you keep by habit steals time from the part only the owner can do.

HOWYOUGRADU AT E

Moving to $5M–$10M You don't need to be perfect. Just these foundations. Achievable within 90 days.

• Business runs 4+ weeks without you - no calls except real emergencies • 3–5 leaders each own a P&L - with real hiring and budget authority • 6-month cash reserve in place, plus a growth fund • Marketing is a department - tracked cost per customer by channel • You know your valuation - and what's dragging the multiplier down

The jump from $2M–$5M to $5M–$10M is not about scaling what you already do. It's about shifting from a well-run business to a valuable one.

Quick check before you move on • One number you will review every week • One task someone else now owns • One process the team can run without asking you

YOUR90 - D AY PLAN

The 10 Actions That Move You to $5M–$10M You're not building from scratch. You're optimising a machine and preparing for the next curve.

WEEK 1–2 WEEK 3–4

1. Get a professional business
1. Hire or brief a marketing agency - set valuation. Know the number. a 5–8% of revenue budget.
2. Identify 3 owner-dependencies that
2. Formalise your referral programme reduce the multiplier. with written incentives.
3. Assign P&L ownership to your top 3
3. Document the full sales process and leaders. train the team on closing.

MONTH 2 MONTH 3

1. Test a 4-week absence. Track what
1. Review valuation against your target happens. multiplier.
2. Start quarterly leadership
2. Plan the next 12 months - what takes development for your top 3 leaders. the multiplier from 3× to 6×?

90 days from now You'll have a valuation, 3 leaders owning P&Ls, a marketing department, and a business starting to look sellable. That's the jump to $5M–$10M.

Priority order Visibility first. Ownership second. Growth third. If you try to grow before the numbers and handoffs are real, you usually just scale the stress.

WHY BERNARD / PBA

You've Read the Roadmap. Now Don't Do It Alone.

Reading a roadmap is easy. Actually changing a factory is not. The owners who break through rarely do it alone: they borrow someone else's 30 years of pattern recognition, their own honest mirror, and their refusal to slip back into the comfort of being busy.

Bernard Powell built Premier Group NZ from scratch into a 200 tonne-per-day manufacturer, #1 NZ Best Workplace and AME Global Lean recognised. He lived every stage of your journey before coaching a single person.

500+ owners coached · 200 tonnes/day factory · #1 NZ Best Workplace · AME Global Lean · 141 five-star reviews

What actually changes when you work with Bernard

1. You stop guessing your numbers. The first session maps true cost per unit and your biggest profit leak. Fixing under-pricing alone often pays for the engagement.

2. You build the leverage you have been missing: systems, SOPs and delegated ownership. The boring work most coaches skip is what turns a factory from a trap into a business.

3. You get someone who has made the mistakes. Bernard has seen the ways NZ manufacturers break and the patterns that get them past $5M+.

4. You do not get a generic playbook. Every session is grounded in your factory, your staff, your market and what you are dealing with this week.

Best fit: owners who want blunt feedback and fast implementation—not vague encouragement while keeping the same bottlenecks.

WHAT OWNERS SAY

Real NZ Owners. Real Results.

> *"Bernard is all go. Full of insights and immediate action. We have been blown away by just how quickly PBA implements and starts bringing positive change." — Adrian Day · NZ Manufacturer*

> *"We have had great help from Bernard at PBA shifting mindset and getting stuff done that would otherwise never have happened." — Patrick Whiteman · NZ Business Owner*

> *"Joining Premier Business Academy was one of the best things we have done in years. We joined because we wanted to improve the life our business gives us." — Joshua Prestidge · NZ Business Owner*

> *"Bernard is the real deal business coach. Genuine, inspiring and full of energy and ideas. I am seeing a real upward trend in my sales results." — Tim Farland · NZ Business Owner*

YOUR NEXT STEP

Stop guessing. Get a Growth Assessment Session. In 45 minutes, a top PBA advisor will help identify where your factory is, what is holding it back and the single most important thing to fix first.

Book Your Free Growth Assessment →

500+ NZ manufacturers coached · 141 five-star reviews · Free, no obligation